

Saan Galing?

"Where's it from?"

A game about the half of media literacy nobody teaches: what happens after you already know it's fake.

Submission	UNESCO Youth Hackathon 2026 - "Play Your Part: Youth Designing the Future of Media and Information Literacy"
Track	MIL Education
Format	Game (browser-based, with printable offline version)
Team	Saan Galing?
Country	Philippines
Playable demo	Demonstrated in the pitch video. Single-file build and Android APK available on request. [optional: paste public URL]

1 · TEAM

NAME	AGE	LOCATION	ROLE ON THIS PROJECT
Jose Gian Tubera	21	Angeles City, Philippines	Team lead. Game design, scenario research, rulebook and document writing. 3rd-year Computer Science.
Allein Edward Miranda	21	Angeles City, Philippines	Front-end. Interface build, design system, mobile layout and accessibility. 3rd-year Computer Science.
Rastafari Khaliel Sarzona	21	Angeles City, Philippines	Back-end. Game state architecture, level data structure and the Android build. 4th-year Computer Science.

All three of us are Computer Science students in Angeles City, Pampanga. We designed, built and shipped the prototype ourselves, including the Android application. Class suspension announcements circulate here every typhoon season, and the decision to attend is rarely the student's own.

2 · PROBLEM STATEMENT

Every typhoon season in the Philippines, fake class suspension announcements circulate faster than real ones. Students stay home from school days that were never cancelled - not

because they were fooled, but because the person who decides was.

This is a documented, recurring and escalating problem. The Department of Education has repeatedly issued public warnings about fake suspension announcements, which it notes are now "usually made using artificial intelligence tools." In one 2025 case DepEd had to publicly debunk an AI-generated video announcing suspensions for a specific Monday. Fact-checkers have separately debunked fabricated suspension claims attributed to a Nipah virus outbreak, an oil price hike, and a blanket suspension "until December."

The infrastructure for this is permanent and deliberate. A Facebook page now operating as "**Walang Pasok Advisory**" was created in November 2023 as a personal account named "Francesca M official," then renamed in July 2024 to appear authoritative. As of March 2026 it carried roughly 38,000 likes and 55,000 followers. The rename is itself the lesson: a page that changed its identity to borrow credibility it never had.

DepEd's own remedy is precisely a media and information literacy instruction - rely only on official sources. But that advice assumes the person receiving it is the person deciding. In a Filipino household, they usually are not.

The gap nobody is addressing

Existing media literacy education stops at detection. It teaches young people to identify a fake. It does not teach them what to do when they have identified one and the adult holding the decision does not believe them.

That gap is where the harm actually occurs. A student can verify a suspension announcement in ninety seconds. Convincing their mother - who received it from a trusted aunt, in a family group chat, alongside a plausible-looking poster - is the part that fails. UNESCO's own 2026 figures frame the same asymmetry: 52% of young people rely on social media and AI for news, while 63% of parents have no idea how their teenagers use AI. The two groups are reading the same information environment with completely different instruments, and only one of them has authority.

The consequence is measurable and it is educational. A missed school day is not an abstraction about trust in institutions. It is lost instruction, in a country where UNESCO's SDG 4 commitment to inclusive and equitable quality education is already under pressure. Fake suspension posts convert misinformation directly into absence from school.

3 · OBJECTIVES

1. **Teach verification as a habit, not a quiz.** By the end of one 20-minute session, a student can name the official source for class suspensions in their own locality and has practised checking it under time pressure.
2. **Teach the second half - persuasion.** Students practise presenting evidence to a resistant family member and experience how credibility is accumulated and spent. This is the objective no existing MIL material addresses.
3. **Reach 300 senior high school students across 4 schools in the Angeles City Schools Division by the end of the 2026 - 2027 school year**, delivered inside the existing mandated Media and Information Literacy subject, and measured against school attendance records on days when a fake suspension circulates.

4 · TARGET AUDIENCE

Primary: Filipino senior high school students in Grades 11 and 12 - the cohort already required to take Media and Information Literacy as a core subject - and, through them, their parents and guardians.

Why this group, specifically: they are old enough to verify information independently and young enough that they do not control the decision. They are the exact population where the detection-to-action gap is widest. They are also reachable through a channel that already exists, at no cost to us: a mandated 80-hour course that every one of them must take.

Secondary beneficiaries: parents and guardians, who are the actual decision-makers and who are reached indirectly - the student brings the argument home. This is deliberate. We do not need parents to install anything.

Inclusion: the game is a text-based chat interface. It runs in any mobile browser, requires no installation, no account, and no sustained connectivity. It is playable on a low-cost Android handset over a weak connection - which matters, because connectivity degrades during exactly the weather events that generate this misinformation. A printable paper version exists for classrooms with no devices at all. All game text is stored as data rather than code, so translation into Cebuano, Ilocano, Hiligaynon and other Philippine languages is a translation task, not a development task.

5 · THE CONCEPT

You run your section's group chat. Forty-two classmates read what you post. Seven sources want you to pass their claim on, and every one of them has documents attached.

The loop

1. **A source arrives** with a claim and a set of attached documents - a page's transparency record, an official memorandum, a reverse image search, a broadcast log.
2. **You read whatever you want.** Checking is free and unlimited, and so is the rulebook. Nothing is rationed.
3. **You accept or reject** the claim into the post you are about to write.
4. **You post once**, composed from everything you accepted.
5. **Your section acts on it**, and the consequences are counted.

The documents never tell you what to think

This is the design decision the whole game rests on. A document states facts and stops. The page transparency record says the page was created in November 2023 as "Francesca M official" and renamed in July 2024 - it does not say "therefore this page is deceptive." A separate document lists its last five posts, all claiming a suspension, against a note that classes were held on those days. The player connects them.

The connection is made possible by a **rulebook**, available at all times, which is where the transferable skill actually lives: local suspensions are declared by the LGU or mayor, not DepEd; PAGASA issues weather signals and never suspends classes; a real advisory carries a reference number, an issuing office, a signature and an explicit scope; legitimate aid never charges a processing fee; a reverse image search shows when a photo first appeared, not just where.

Both failure modes are on the scoreboard

Letting a lie through costs your classmates a school day, or the money they paid a scam. But **holding back something true costs them as well**, and the game counts it in its own column. Every level contains at least one claim that is genuinely official and genuinely useful but narrower than it looks - a barangay memorandum suspending classes for elementary pupils in one barangay only. Reject it and eleven classmates with younger siblings never hear about it.

The result is that reject-everything is not a winning strategy. This matters because blanket cynicism - "everything online is fake" - is the failure mode media literacy education produces by accident, and it is at least as damaging as credulity.

The game also records how many documents you opened. A player who judges every source correctly without reading anything is told so plainly: *you may have been right; you were not checking*. No points are deducted, because being accidentally right is still being right - but it is not the habit the game exists to build.

Three levels, three skills

LEVEL	THEME	WHAT IT TEACHES
1 · Walang pasok	Fake class suspension announcements	Who is actually authorised to declare it, and what a genuine advisory contains
2 · Ang ayuda	Cash aid and scholarship scams	Official domains, forged memoranda, and the processing fee that gives it away
3 · Ang nawawala	Recycled appeals and panic posts	Reverse image search - where an image came from, and <i>when</i>

Each level carries its own rulebook chapter, so the levels function as curriculum units rather than additional content. Levels are defined as data, not code: adding a fourth is adding a data object, and translating the game is a translation task rather than a development one.

Prototype status

A complete, playable prototype exists: three levels, nineteen sources, thirty-two documents, the full rulebook, scoring and consequences. It is a single HTML file with no dependencies and no backend, it runs offline in any mobile browser, and and it has also been built and installed as a 4 MB Android application on a physical handset. The full loop is demonstrated in the pitch video.

[optional: paste public URL]

6 · SUSTAINABILITY

There is already a mandated course waiting for this

The Philippines was among the first countries in the world to make Media and Information Literacy part of basic education. It is a **core subject in senior high school - one semester, 80 hours, Grade 11 or 12**. We are not asking schools to create space. The slot exists, it is compulsory, and teachers need materials for it. UNESCO's own figure is that only 43% of countries have integrated MIL

into their curricula; the Philippines is inside that 43%, which makes it a proving ground for a package that can then be handed to the 57% that are not.

The problem runs on a calendar

Typhoon season recurs annually, June to November, indefinitely. Add first-day-of-class hoaxes and exam periods. Unlike most media literacy interventions, this one has a natural annual moment of deployment, which means schools redeploy it every year rather than using it once.

It costs almost nothing to run

Static browser application. No backend, no accounts, no server costs, no per-user fees. A free hosting tier serves a national audience. This is also the argument for on-device inference in the roadmap: cloud-hosted language models would incur a per-student cost forever, whereas an on-device model is a one-time download. The scripted version remains the default and the model is a progressive enhancement only where the device supports it - an important constraint given our users' hardware.

We can measure it with data that already exists

When a fake suspension circulates, absences spike. Schools already record attendance. We can therefore measure real behavioural change - not self-reported confidence - by comparing absence rates on fake-suspension days between schools that have run the game and those that have not, at zero instrumentation cost. Very few media literacy interventions can measure anything beyond a satisfaction survey.

Risks we are naming rather than hiding

RISK	MITIGATION
Our team ages out or graduates.	The game is designed to be run by a MIL teacher with no involvement from us. Open licence, plus an institutional home with our university's computer science student organisation, with the Angeles City Schools Division as the intended long-term home.
Scenarios become dated as tactics change.	Scenarios are data, not code. Teachers can author new ones; we publish an annual scenario pack.
On-device model size on low-cost phones.	Scripted version is the default and is fully functional. The model is optional enhancement.
Discovery without a marketing budget.	Distribution through DepEd regional and division offices and campus organisations, not app stores.

Horizon

- **0 - 3 months** - pilot in 2 schools in the Angeles City Schools Division; baseline against attendance records.
- **3 - 12 months** - three Philippine languages, teacher toolkit, scenario authoring tool, division-wide rollout.
- **Year 2 - 3** - additional regions; adaptation by other countries with the same pattern (fake holiday and closure announcements are documented in India, Indonesia, Nigeria and Brazil); on-device model where hardware allows.

7 · CREATIVITY AND FEASIBILITY

What is original here is not the subject matter but where the difficulty sits. Every media literacy game we are aware of ends at the moment of detection. Ours spends half of each round after that moment, on the social problem of being believed - and it makes trust a resource with a memory, so credibility accumulates across a school year. We are not aware of another MIL product that models persuasion as the scarce resource, or that penalises reflexive cynicism as heavily as it penalises credulity.

What is already done: a complete playable prototype of one school year, built and deployed; the full scenario structure; the trust and consequence systems; the end-of-year assessment screen. The prototype has been played end to end by the team on both desktop and an Android handset; it has not yet been tested with a classroom group.

What makes it realistic: it is a text-based browser game. There is no hardware, no distribution deal, no procurement, and no per-user cost. The single largest dependency - a place to use it - already exists as a compulsory subject.

8 · ALIGNMENT WITH MIL AND THIS YEAR'S THEME

Theme. "Play Your Part" is the question the game asks in every round: what is your role inside your own family's information network? The player is never a passive recipient. They are assigned a part they must actually perform, against resistance.

Five Laws of MIL. The trust meter is a direct expression of the fifth law - *"Media and information literacy is not acquired at once. It is a lived and dynamic experience and process."* Credibility in our game cannot be earned in a single round; it accumulates across a school year, and it can be lost. The third law - that information is not value-neutral - is embodied in the aunt: the message is identical whether a stranger or a family member sends it, and only the relationship changes.

MIL competencies addressed: locating and identifying authoritative sources; evaluating a claim against a source under time constraint; understanding how social trust shapes credibility independently of evidence; and communicating verified information to others - the "create and disseminate" component of MIL that detection-focused material routinely omits.

SDG 4. The measurable outcome of this project is school attendance. It addresses misinformation specifically at the point where it removes children from classrooms.

Before you export: replace every highlighted placeholder, delete this footer, check the file is under 10 MB, and confirm the demo URL opens in a private browsing window.

Sources for all figures cited: UNESCO Youth Hackathon 2026 call and Global MIL Week 2026 (#WeAllPlayAPart) campaign figures; DepEd public advisories on AI-generated class suspension announcements as reported by the Philippine Daily Inquirer and GMA News; MindaNews fact-check of the "Walang Pasok Advisory" page (March 2026); DepEd Media and Information Literacy Curriculum Guide, senior high school core subject.